and Komer thought that pressing a weak Indian government to negotiate on Kashmir would lead to instability that China could exploit.[167] And Harriman bluntly told the Pakistani ambassador that "US ability to bring pressure to bear upon India is limited by our confrontation with [the] Chicom threat and activities in [the] area and elsewhere around the world."[168]

The Pakistani attitude toward China also prevented further US pressure on India, particularly in the context of Johnson's frustration with Southeast Asia Treaty Organization member Pakistan's lack of support on Vietnam. With Ayub suggesting that American aid to India would lead Pakistan to seek Chinese "protection" and re-evaluate its alliance commitments, Johnson said the US would then also "reexamine" its relationship with Pakistan. He instructed McConaughy to convey his unhappiness about the deepening Sino-Pakistan relationship, especially given the trouble China was creating for the US in Southeast Asia.[169] Bundy bluntly told the Pakistani finance minister that Pakistan should not

> be under any illusion that leaning on the US or making noises toward China would change our determination to help India against China. This was a major aspect of our foreign policy. The Paks might disagree with our judgment as to the reliability of India and whether the Indians would ever fight China. But this was not the issue. We regarded India as a very important place and were determined to avoid the critical vacuum which would be created by India's collapse.[170]

Even as the administration saw Pakistan as part of its own China problem, however, it still believed that India should make Pakistan part of its China solution. But Indian officials increasingly saw their China and Pakistan problems as combined. Indian officials, as the cabinet secretary later put it, saw the two countries as "united in a strange marriage of convenience," making it harder to deal with Pakistan on other issues such as Kashmir.[171] There were few takers for American suggestions of concessions to Pakistan. A range of developments had hardened positions: a local crisis in Kashmir in December 1963, a refugee influx from East Pakistan through most of 1964, and India's December 1964 announcement that it was taking steps to formally integrate Kashmir, as well as visits by Zhou to Pakistan in